

PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR

Mamta Meena, *25*
Chalkchandpur, Rajasthan, *Farmer*

Constituency: Dausa

Issues that will decide her vote: More jobs for her Meena (ST) community

Demands from the govt: Our income should double as PM Modi has promised

The Local Roadblock

Mamta comes from a BPL family but Chalkchandpur is a prosperous village of 2,000 families. Her son is in Class 3 and her daughter in Class 1 in a government school. She's happy that there are teachers at the school and doctors at the dispensaries and the fact that she gets free medicines. Mamta studied till Class 12 while her husband, Jaldari Meena,

"Modi is good as PM, but what can he do in a village? In the village, it is the *sarpanch* who matters"

is an ITI graduate and has done a course in computer programming.

However, despite their Scheduled Tribe (ST) reserved status, he has found it hard to land a job. The couple make a living by farming on their small holding. "There are too many job applicants, too few vacancies," she says. She gets free rations, subsidy for an LPG cylinder and assistance to build a toilet but not for a house. "It all depends on the *sarpanch*," she says. At the Centre, she likes Modi as PM but in the state feels that the former Congress government led by Ashok Gehlot was more welfare-oriented. ■

-Rohit Parihar



SUMIT KUMAR

Suman Devi, *32*
Hariharpur, UP
Homemaker

Constituency: Kheri

Issues that will decide her vote: Inflation, lack of government facilities
Demands from the govt: A ration card that can help her avail of welfare schemes

Give Us Just the Bare Minimum

Suman Devi is not against any political party. But she is angry with the local officials. Reason: A ration card, which could have helped her avail of the government